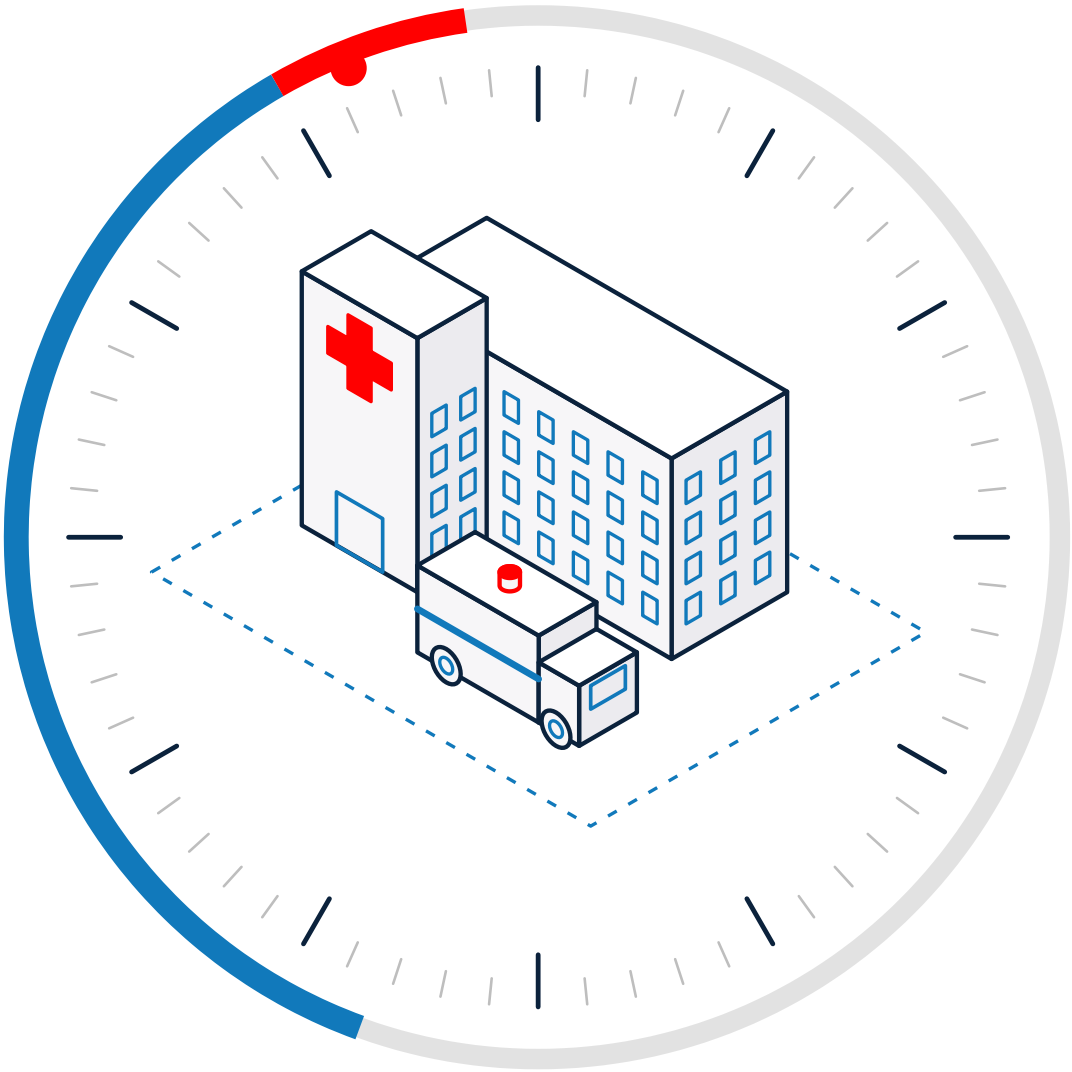


HEALTHCARE · INTELLIGENCE REPORT

When the lab went dark.

A UK pathology outage, two years on, and what it teaches hospitals everywhere. What happens to patients, blood stocks and staff when a clinical system fails, and how to get the first hour right.

INSIDE

Contents

An evidence-based look at the 2024 Synnovis attack in the UK and its long tail, set beside US cases and the rules in the UK, US, EU and Middle East, with lessons for hospitals and health systems anywhere.

Executive summary 03

Key findings 04

01 The attack 07

02 The pattern 11

03 What to do 17

Coordination, use cases, readiness and buyer's guide 22

Sources 27

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

One laboratory outage. Two years of recovery.

United Kingdom: on 3 June 2024 a ransomware attack on Synnovis, which provides pathology services to major hospitals in south east London, stopped normal blood testing. Guy's and St Thomas' and King's College Hospital declared a critical incident the next morning, with blood transfusions particularly affected.[1] NHS England later reported that 10,152 acute outpatient appointments and 1,710 elective procedures were postponed at the two trusts.[2]

The effects travelled far beyond the laboratory. The national blood service appealed for O type donors within a week and in July 2024 issued a national amber alert, saying the London hospitals had needed 94 per cent more O negative blood than a year earlier.[3,4] In June 2025 King's College Hospital confirmed that a long wait for a blood test result caused by the attack was one of the factors that contributed to a patient's death.[5] Almost two years on, one provider was still in business continuity for pathology.[6]

The pattern is international. **United States:** in 2024 a ransomware attack on Change Healthcare disrupted claims and payments for providers and, UnitedHealth later estimated, affected the data of about 190 million people; an attack on Ascension forced several hospitals to divert ambulances and move to paper records.[7,8] And not every incident is cyber: in 2026 English hospitals declared critical incidents over IT failures and heat-related cooling failures.[9,10]

This report sets out the evidence, compares it with earlier lessons and the rules in the UK, the US, the EU and the Middle East, and ends with practical recommendations for any hospital or health system.

THE BOTTOM LINE

Assume that a clinical system will fail. Declare early in agreed words, reach and confirm the right staff in minutes, run practised downtime procedures with your suppliers, and keep patients and partners informed until the last result is back in the record.

KEY FINDINGS

Seven things the evidence tells us

01 A supplier incident is a clinical incident.

In the UK case, Synnovis was a pathology partner, not a hospital, but the disruption landed on wards, clinics, GP practices and the blood supply.[1,2,4]

02 The harm was real and is now documented.

UK reporting in June 2025 linked 170 cases of patient harm, most of them low harm, to nearly 600 incidents, and a hospital confirmed the attack contributed to a death.[5,11]

03 Blood is the sharpest edge.

Without normal matching, the London hospitals relied on O type blood, and national O negative stocks fell to 1.6 days.[3,4]

04 Recovery takes far longer than response.

Almost two years on, one UK provider was still in business continuity for pathology results.[6]

05 It is not only a UK problem.

In the US, the Change Healthcare and Ascension attacks in 2024 disrupted payments, patient records and ambulance flows.[7,8]

06 Not every critical incident is cyber.

In 2026 English hospitals declared critical incidents over IT failures and heat-related cooling failures that stopped theatres and scanners.[9,10,12]

07 Reporting clocks are short, and they differ.

Under the EU's NIS2, an early warning is due within 24 hours; in England, NIS reporting for health is 72 hours, with 24 hours proposed.[13,14,15]

AT A GLANCE

The outage and its echoes, in six figures

Each figure is sourced. Where sources measure different things, we say so in the analysis that follows.

10,152

Acute outpatient appointments postponed at the two most affected London trusts (UK), according to NHS England.[2]

1,710

Elective procedures postponed at the same two trusts.[2]

94%

Increase in O negative blood needed by the affected London hospitals, against the same period a year earlier.[4]

170

Cases of patient harm linked to the Synnovis attack, as reported in June 2025; most were classed as low harm.[11]

161,560

Pathology reports one UK provider estimated were delayed being entered into patient records, as of early January 2026.[6]

190m

People whose data UnitedHealth estimated was affected by the 2024 Change Healthcare attack in the US.[7]

TIMELINE

From WannaCry to a summer of critical incidents

Key dates, UK unless marked. Later reporting on long incidents can revise earlier figures.

12 May 2017 — **WannaCry**
A worldwide ransomware outbreak disrupts at least 81 NHS trusts in England.[16]

February 2024 — **Change Healthcare (US)**
Ransomware disrupts claims and payments for US providers.[7]

May 2024 — **Ascension (US)**
Several hospitals divert ambulances; staff move to paper records.[8]

3 to 4 June 2024 — **Synnovis attack**
Critical incident declared at Guy's and St Thomas' and King's College Hospital.[1]

25 July 2024 — **National amber alert**
The national blood service asks hospitals to restrict O type blood to essential cases.[4]

26 November 2024 — **Wirral major incident**
A trust declares a major incident for cyber security reasons.[17]

June 2025 — **Harm confirmed**
A trust confirms the attack contributed to a patient's death.[5]

June 2026 — **Data and heat**
A trust confirms data on 32,927 patients was stolen; heat forces critical incidents.[10,18]

29 July 2026 — **IT critical incident**
East Kent Hospitals declares a critical incident over IT problems.[9]

PART 01

The attack.

What happened when a UK pathology partner was hit, and how far the effects travelled.

01 From laboratory to ward

02 How a supplier outage spreads

03 Reading the numbers

THE ATTACK

From laboratory to ward in one morning

> **Pathology sits underneath almost everything a hospital does.**

Synnovis is a pathology partnership that runs laboratory services for hospitals and GP practices in south east London, in the UK. On Monday 3 June 2024 a ransomware attack took its systems offline. By Tuesday morning Guy's and St Thomas' and King's College Hospital had declared a critical incident, and the chief executive of one trust told staff that blood transfusions were particularly affected.[1]

Pathology sits underneath almost everything a hospital does. Without results, surgeons cannot confirm a patient is fit for theatre, emergency teams wait longer to rule conditions in or out, and family doctors cannot manage long-term conditions. NHS England's tally of 10,152 outpatient appointments and 1,710 elective procedures postponed at the two trusts captures only part of that.[2]

Blood was the most visible pressure. NHS Blood and Transplant said the affected hospitals could not match patients' blood at the usual frequency, so they relied on O type blood, which is safe for all patients.[3] On 25 July it issued a national amber alert: O negative stocks stood at 1.6 days and the London hospitals had needed an extra 1.7 days of O negative since June.[4] The alert was stood down from 21 July 2025, almost a year later.[19]

Harm followed. Reporting in June 2025 described nearly 600 incidents linked to the attack, 170 of them involving harm to patients, most of it low harm.[11] The same month King's College Hospital said a patient safety investigation had identified a long wait for a blood test result due to the attack as one of several contributing factors in a patient's death.[5]

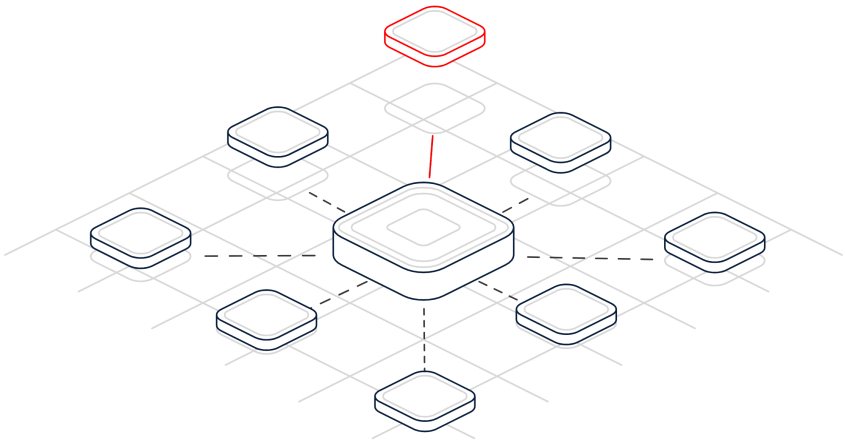
Then came the long tail. Synnovis said in November 2025 that its review of the stolen data was complete; it described the data as unstructured, incomplete and fragmented.[20] In June 2026 Bedfordshire Hospitals confirmed that data on 32,927 of its patients had been taken.[18] And in April 2026 one mental health trust in south London was still in business continuity, with 122 recorded patient safety incidents involving incorrect, unavailable or delayed results.[6]

None of this is a judgement on the people who responded. Clinicians, scientists and managers worked around the clock. It is a measure of how deeply one system runs through modern care, in any country.

HOW IT SPREADS

Four routes from one supplier to every patient

How the Synnovis disruption travelled, as described by NHS England, NHS Blood and Transplant and the trusts (UK).



01 **Results stop**

Tests cannot be requested, processed or reported normally, so clinicians work blind or on paper.[1,3]

02 **Planned care slows**

Operations and clinics that depend on results are postponed and rebooked.[2]

03 **Blood stocks fall**

Hospitals use more universal O type blood, which puts pressure on the national supply.[3,4]

04 **Records lag behind**

Results reach patient records months later, and stolen data surfaces years later.[6,18]

READING THE NUMBERS

What each figure actually counts

Figures from long incidents change as reviews finish. None should be read as the full cost to patients.

FIGURE	SOURCE	WHAT IT MEASURES
10,152 and 1,710	NHS England[2]	Outpatient appointments and elective procedures postponed at the two most affected trusts. Excludes GP and other services.
94%	NHSBT, July 2024[4]	Extra O negative blood needed by the affected London hospitals since June, compared with the same period a year earlier.
170	HSJ via PA, June 2025[11]	Cases of harm among nearly 600 incidents linked to the attack. Severity counts differ between reports, so we give only the total.
161,560	Trust estimate via The Record[6]	Pathology reports whose entry into records at one trust had been delayed, as of early January 2026.
32,927	Bedfordshire Hospitals[18]	Patients whose data was stolen. Other trusts have published their own counts.
UK total	Synnovis[20]	Synnovis has not published how many people's data was affected.

PART 02

The pattern.

Synnovis was not the first major incident to start in IT, and it will not be the last, in the UK or anywhere else.

01 What WannaCry taught

02 Incidents in the UK and the US

03 What the UK framework expects

04 How the rules differ by region

05 Where providers fall short

THE PATTERN

What WannaCry taught, and what it did not

> **The common thread is not the cause. It is the first hour.**

On Friday 12 May 2017 the WannaCry ransomware spread worldwide. In England, the National Audit Office found that at least 81 of the 236 NHS trusts were affected, along with 603 primary care and other NHS organisations, including 595 GP practices.[16] NHS England recorded 6,912 cancelled appointments and estimated that over 19,000 would have been cancelled in total. Five A&E departments diverted patients.[16]

The NAO's findings on the response read as a checklist for today. The Department of Health had a plan with defined roles, but had not tested it at a local level. Many local organisations could not reach national bodies by email, and locally staff shared information through personal mobile devices, including WhatsApp.[16]

Synnovis was different in one important way: the system that failed belonged to a partner. That pattern repeats. **United States:** the February 2024 attack on Change Healthcare, a claims and payments business, left providers unable to get paid, verify insurance or file prior authorisations.[7] **United Kingdom:** an ICO penalty notice in March 2025 fined Advanced, a software supplier, about £3.07m after a 2022 ransomware attack that disrupted NHS 111.[21]

Hospital systems are hit directly too. In May 2024 a cyber attack on Ascension, which operates 140 hospitals in 19 US states, took its electronic records offline; several hospitals diverted ambulances and staff moved to paper.[8] In the UK, Wirral declared a major incident for cyber security reasons in November 2024.[17]

And not every critical incident is a cyber attack. In June 2026 a Portsmouth hospital declared a critical incident when chillers failed in a heatwave, affecting digital systems, theatres, cardiac catheter laboratories and scanning; another trust lost its MRI scanners to the heat.[10,12] In July 2026 East Kent Hospitals declared one over IT problems without, at first, knowing the cause.[9]

The common thread is not the cause. It is the first hour: who declares, who is called in, how staff and patients are told, and whether care can carry on without the system.

SINCE 2017

Healthcare incidents that started in technology or the plant room

A selection with public, sourced detail. Causes and impacts are as reported by the organisations or regulators.

INCIDENT	WHAT HAPPENED	WHAT IT SHOWS
WannaCry, UK, May 2017	Ransomware across the NHS; at least 81 trusts affected.[16]	Plans must be tested locally, with a fallback channel.
Change Healthcare, US, Feb 2024	Ransomware at a claims and payments business; data of about 190 million people affected.[7]	A supplier far from the ward can stop the business of care.
Ascension, US, May 2024	Records offline; several hospitals divert ambulances; paper working.[8]	Downtime procedures are needed at scale, for weeks.
Synnovis, UK, June 2024	Ransomware at a pathology partner; critical incident at two trusts.[1]	Supplier failure becomes clinical risk and a national blood issue.
Wirral, UK, November 2024	Major incident declared for cyber security reasons; outpatients cancelled.[17]	Hospitals do declare major incidents for cyber attacks.
Advanced, UK, fined March 2025	ICO fine of about £3.07m for a 2022 attack that disrupted NHS 111.[21]	Regulators now act against suppliers.
Heatwave, UK, June 2026	Chillers fail; theatres, cath labs and scanning affected.[10,12]	Estates and digital failures arrive together.
East Kent, UK, July 2026	Critical incident over IT problems of unknown cause.[9]	Declare first; find the cause later.

THE UK FRAMEWORK

United Kingdom: what NHS England's framework expects

> **The tools exist. The question is whether they are practised.**

This page describes England. Every NHS-funded organisation there works to the NHS Emergency Preparedness, Resilience and Response Framework. Version 3, published in July 2022, defines a business continuity incident, a critical incident and a major incident, and sets incident response levels from 1, managed within one organisation, to 4, led nationally by NHS England.[22]

A critical incident, in the framework's words, is any localised incident where the level of disruption results in an organisation temporarily or permanently losing its ability to deliver critical services, or where patients and staff may be at risk of harm. It is principally an internal escalation response, and the framework asks organisations to use the format “Critical Incident declared by (organisation)”.[22]

The framework also sets out standard major incident messages, the METHANE and SBAR formats for sharing information, a 24/7 on-call system with a director able to allocate resources, and notification to the integrated care board, which informs NHS England through regional on-call. It expects a hot debrief within 48 hours of stand down and a structured debrief within 28 days.[22]

Compliance is tested every year against the NHS Core Standards for EPRR. The NHS Standard Contract requires providers of NHS-funded services, including independent providers, to comply with EPRR guidance.[22] NHS England grades organisations from fully compliant, meeting 100 per cent of the relevant standards, through substantial and partial to non-compliant, and its 2026/27 process keeps the approach of previous years.[23] In the 2024 round, one acute trust reported assessing itself against 62 core standards, plus a deep dive of 11 standards on cyber security.[24]

Cyber incidents carry extra duties. NHS trusts, foundation trusts, integrated care boards and certain independent providers are operators of essential services under the NIS Regulations, and must report network and information system incidents through the DSPT no later than 72 hours after becoming aware.[14] The Cyber Security and Resilience Bill proposes an initial notice within 24 hours and a full report within 72 hours; those measures would follow Royal Assent and secondary legislation.[15]

Pressure from demand is measured separately, through the OPEL framework, which leaves declaring an incident as a decision for the provider under the EPRR framework.[25] The tools exist. The question is whether they are practised.

REGIONAL NOTES

How the rules differ: preparedness and reporting

The first hour looks the same everywhere. The rules around it do not. A summary of what applies to hospitals in each region, and how fast a cyber or data incident must be reported.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED KINGDOM

England: NHS-funded providers work to the EPRR Framework and annual Core Standards assurance.[22,23] Operators of essential services in health report network and information system incidents through the DSPT within 72 hours; a Bill proposes a 24-hour initial notice.[14,15]

IN PRACTICE Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland have their own arrangements. Data breaches can need a separate report to the data protection regulator.

REGIONAL NOTE · EUROPEAN UNION

Preparedness is set nationally. Under NIS2, health is a sector of high criticality: an early warning within 24 hours of becoming aware of a significant incident, a notification within 72 hours and a final report within one month.[13] The CER Directive covers health; critical entities were to be identified by 17 July 2026.[30]

IN PRACTICE Both directives work through national law, transposed from 17 October 2024. Check your hospital's status with your national authority.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED STATES

Medicare and Medicaid hospitals must meet the CMS emergency preparedness rule, 42 CFR 482.15: all-hazards plan, communication plan, training and testing, reviewed at least every 2 years, with exercises twice a year.[26] The Joint Commission's revised Emergency Management standards apply to accredited hospitals from July 2022.[27] HIPAA breach notices to individuals are due within 60 days of discovery.[28]

IN PRACTICE Many hospitals run their response with the Hospital Incident Command System (HICS).[29]

REGIONAL NOTE · MIDDLE EAST (UAE AND SAUDI ARABIA)

Dubai: the DHA healthcare emergencies framework, effective 14 January 2025, requires annual hazard analysis, an emergency operations centre for hospitals, a 24/7 contact for DHA and at least one exercise a year.[31] **Abu Dhabi** launched a healthcare business continuity standard in May 2025.[32] The UAE national standard is AE/SCNS/NCEMA 7000:2021.[33]

IN PRACTICE **Saudi Arabia:** CBAHI accreditation is linked to hospital licence renewal.[34] JCI surveys use its 8th edition hospital standards from 1 January 2025.[35]

A summary for orientation, not legal advice. Requirements depend on sector, size, licence and jurisdiction, and change over time. Confirm the current text with your legal and compliance teams.

COMMON GAPS

Where providers fall short in the first hour

The gap is rarely the plan. It is practice, people and partners.

AREA	WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Declaring	Teams fix quietly and declare late, waiting for certainty.	Written triggers, named roles with authority, agreed wording.
Calling staff in	Phone trees and email; nobody knows who is coming.	Role-based alerts on several channels, with acknowledgement and escalation.
Suppliers	The lab, record or estates partner is not on the call list.	Joint call lists, joint exercises and a shared incident log.
Downtime	Folders exist but have not been used this year.	Printed, practised procedures, including transfusion and results back-entry.
Communication	Staff rely on personal messaging when email fails.	An agreed out-of-band channel and fixed update times.
Recovery	The incident is closed while results are still missing.	A recovery cell and debriefs on a set timetable.
Staff welfare	The same people work the first twelve hours and the next day.	Rotas planned in the first hour, welfare checks and a clear stand down.

PART 03

What to do now.

What the evidence means for hospitals and health systems, and the steps that close the gap.

01 What it means for organisations in healthcare

02 Recommendations

03 Questions for the board

WHAT IT MEANS

What it means for organisations in healthcare

> **If your laboratory system went dark at 08:10 tomorrow, who would declare?**

For hospitals, the first lesson is that resilience now runs through partners. Pathology networks, imaging, electronic records, claims and payments, estates and community services are often delivered by other organisations. If they are not on your incident call lists, and you are not on theirs, the first hour will be spent finding phone numbers.[1,7]

For health systems, the second lesson is scale. Ascension's attack took offline the electronic records of a system with 140 hospitals in 19 states; Synnovis touched every hospital and practice that relied on one laboratory.[2,8] Incident command has to work across sites, with one picture of who is coming in and what is still open.

For boards, the question is not whether a plan exists. The NAO's finding after WannaCry was that the plan had not been tested locally.[16] Regulators and accreditors ask for exercises; in the US, CMS expects at least two a year.[26] Boards should ask for evidence: time to declare, time to confirm staff, time to the first paper result.

For seasonal peaks, the risks stack. An IT failure on a day of full emergency departments and staff sickness leaves little slack. Linking your escalation levels to incident triggers and call-in lists means the response grows with the pressure.

For compliance, the clocks are short and they differ: 24 hours for an early warning under NIS2, 72 hours under England's NIS rules, 60 days for HIPAA breach notices to individuals.[13,14,28] Know which apply before the day.

The practical test is simple. If your laboratory system went dark at 08:10 tomorrow, who would declare, how quickly would you know who was coming in, and could every ward get an urgent result on paper?

RECOMMENDATIONS

Seven steps for hospitals and health systems

In priority order. The first three can start straight away.

01 Write declaration triggers

Use your framework's definitions and wording; name who can declare.

02 Call staff in by role, and confirm

Alerts by role on several channels, with acknowledgement and escalation.

03 Agree an out-of-band channel

Decide how staff talk if email is down or untrusted.[16]

04 Put suppliers on your incident lists

Laboratory, imaging, records, payments and estates, with joint exercises.[2,7]

05 Practise downtime, including blood

Paper requests, phoned results, O type use and back-entry.[3,6]

06 Know your reporting clocks

Cyber, data protection and health regulator, by region.[13,28]

07 Debrief and report on time

Hot debrief within 48 hours, then a structured review with dated actions.

FOR THE BOARD

Questions boards should ask

Answers should be specific, dated and owned.

READINESS

- ? Who can declare a critical incident tonight, and when did we last test that they would?
- ? How long does it take us to confirm who is coming in after a call-in?
- ? Could every ward get an urgent blood result with no computers?

PARTNERS AND RECOVERY

- ? Which suppliers could stop clinical care or payments, and are they in our incident plans?
- ? Which cyber and data reports would we owe, to whom, and how fast?
- ? How do we look after the staff who carry a long incident?

GLOSSARY

Terms used in this report

EPRR
Emergency preparedness, resilience and response: the NHS England framework for incidents (UK).

Business continuity incident
Disruption to normal service below acceptable levels that needs special arrangements.

Critical incident
Localised loss of ability to deliver critical services, or risk of harm to patients and staff.

Major incident
An event with serious consequences needing special arrangements by one or more responder agencies.

HICS
Hospital Incident Command System: an incident command framework for hospitals, used widely in the US.

Core Standards
The minimum EPRR requirements NHS-funded organisations in England assess themselves against each year.

Pathology
Laboratory testing of blood, tissue and other samples.

O negative
The universal donor blood type, used when a patient's blood cannot be matched.

Ransomware
Malicious software that locks or steals data to extort payment.

NIS and NIS2
UK regulations and an EU directive that set security and incident reporting duties for essential services, including health.

DSPT
The Data Security and Protection Toolkit, used to report incidents in health and care in England.

JCI and CBAHI
Joint Commission International and Saudi Arabia's national accreditation body for healthcare.

WHY COORDINATION, NOT JUST NOTIFICATION

Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.

When pathology goes down at 08:10, the alert is minute one. Keeping patients safe depends on who declared what, which staff came in, which downtime procedures started, what partners and patients were told, and a record for the after-action review.

WHERE INCIDENTS GO WRONG

01	**Fragmented information**	Different teams work from different information.
02	**Delayed decision making**	Leadership lacks visibility, so decisions wait.
03	**Uncoordinated response**	Several teams work independently on the same problem.
04	**Lack of visibility**	Critical actions become difficult to track.
05	**Lack of accountability**	Actions and decisions are poorly documented.

THE WHOLE INCIDENT, IN ONE PLATFORM



Crises Control is an **Operational Incident Coordination Platform**. It helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform.

WHAT IS STANDARD, WHAT IS CONFIGURED

Clear about what the platform does.

Some capabilities work as standard. Others depend on how your team sets up plans, groups and rules, or on connecting your own systems. Your demonstration and implementation plan confirm what applies to you.

STANDARD	CONFIGURED	INTEGRATIONS
Included in how each module works.	Set up by your team to match your plans.	Connected to your other systems, where configured.
SOS press-and-hold alert from the mobile app, raising an incident and sharing location where available	Response plans, task lists and message templates per incident type	Directory sync with Microsoft Entra ID, SCIM or scheduled file import
Ping alerts by push, SMS, voice, email and desktop, with one-tap acknowledgement	Groups, sites and audiences to target	Single sign-on with Entra ID, Google Workspace or Okta
Incident Manager workspace, roles and a single communication log	Escalation rules and timings when people do not respond	The Microsoft Teams app, enabled by your administrator
Task Manager tasks with owners and deadlines when a plan is activated	Cascading from one channel to the next	Triggers from monitoring or other systems, set up as an integration project
Control Centre live view of status, acknowledgements, tasks and locations	Response options people can choose when they acknowledge	
Audit & Reporting: timestamped records, exportable as PDF or CSV		
CRAiG (beta): answers questions and summarises your incident data within each user's permissions		

> Crises Control does not detect incidents on its own. Incidents are raised by people, through SOS, the app or the web, or by connected systems where an integration has been configured. From that point the platform coordinates the response.

USE CASES

How organisations use Crises Control in healthcare

Code Blue and urgent clinical team mobilisation

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER A medical emergency requires an immediate response from a designated clinical team

Allow authorised staff to launch the incident, alert the response team, track individual acknowledgements and monitor staff availability.

Incident Manager | Ping | acknowledgement tracking | Control Centre

Code White and Code Yellow response

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER A hospital activates an established internal emergency protocol

Notify relevant management and response personnel, assign protocol-related tasks and coordinate the response in line with hospital procedures.

Incident Manager | Ping | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

Major incident and multi-department coordination

SUGGESTED APPLICATION

TRIGGER A major event requires clinical, operational, digital and management teams to work together

Activate the relevant response group, coordinate communications, distribute actions and monitor progress across teams.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

Disaster recovery and system downtime

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER A hospital information system or other critical technology service is disrupted

Communicate recovery or downtime procedures, distribute tasks across departments and coordinate the response. Automated plan triggering depends on configured integrations and workflows.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | integrations where configured | Audit & Reporting

Temperature monitoring and cold-storage alerts

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER A warehouse cooling system moves outside its acceptable temperature range

Use configured monitoring triggers to alert relevant employees when temperatures fall outside defined thresholds, then coordinate follow-up actions.

Ping | configured integrations or triggers | Task Manager

IT and operational disruption notifications

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER An IT service or business application becomes unavailable

Notify relevant IT teams and employees, provide updates and coordinate any required follow-up actions.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Audit & Reporting

On-call and surgical team mobilisation

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER An urgent clinical situation requires rapid mobilisation of on-call physicians or surgical teams

Alert the designated team, collect acknowledgements and availability, and provide visibility of who has responded.

Ping | Incident Manager | acknowledgement tracking | Control Centre

Simulation tests and response readiness

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER Clinical teams need to practise emergency procedures and confirm readiness

Run simulation incidents and test alerts, verify that teams can be reached and review participation and response records.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Audit & Reporting

Customer examples are based on how customers use Crises Control today; customer names have been removed. Customer requirements describe needs raised by customers or in evaluations. Intended, suggested and illustrative use cases show how the platform can be applied and are not presented as existing customer deployments. Capabilities marked 'where configured' or 'where supported' depend on each organisation's set-up.

READINESS ASSESSMENT

How ready is your response?

Score each area from 0 (not in place) to 3 (fully in place) for your healthcare organisation, then add up the total.

AREA	THE QUESTION	SCORE 0 TO 3
01 · ACTIVATION **Alert**	Can you reach the right people on more than one channel within minutes, day or night? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Clinical, on-call and support staff reached on several channels, at any hour.	0 1 2 3
02 · ACTIVATION **Acknowledge**	Do you know who has seen the alert, and does silence trigger escalation by rule? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Call-in responses tracked, with escalation when key roles stay silent.	0 1 2 3
03 · COORDINATION **Escalate**	Are escalation paths set by role and time, not by whoever remembers who to call? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Declaration and escalation follow your emergency preparedness framework by role.	0 1 2 3
04 · COORDINATION **Coordinate**	Is there one shared workspace and log for the incident, not scattered calls, chats and inboxes? GOOD LOOKS LIKE One incident log shared by the incident team, clinical leads, partners and communications.	0 1 2 3
05 · EXECUTION **Execute**	Are your procedures turned into owned tasks with deadlines that someone can track? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Downtime procedures run as owned tasks in every affected department.	0 1 2 3
06 · EXECUTION **See**	Can leaders see tasks, people, locations and blockers live, without having to ask? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A live view of staff mobilised, services affected and actions outstanding.	0 1 2 3
07 · ASSURANCE **Prove**	Could you produce a timestamped timeline for a regulator, insurer or inquiry within a day? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A timeline that supports assurance, data protection regulators and the after-action review.	0 1 2 3
08 · ASSURANCE **Rehearse**	Do you exercise the whole response, not just the call tree, at least once a year? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Exercises that include a cyber attack on clinical systems, not just a major incident.	0 1 2 3

0 to 8
Alerting only
You can send messages. The response still depends on people and luck.

9 to 16
Coordinating in parts
Some steps work. Gaps appear at night, at scale or when systems fail.

17 to 24
Coordinated and provable
You can run the response and show exactly what happened.

BUYER'S GUIDE

Eight questions to ask any incident platform supplier

Many tools can send an alert. These questions separate a notification tool from a platform that coordinates the whole response.

01 **Does it stop at the message?**
Ask what the platform does after the alert is sent: tasks, log, escalation, recovery.

02 **Can it prove who acknowledged?**
Delivery is not acknowledgement. Ask how silence is spotted and escalated, and what you must configure.

03 **Does it run your procedures?**
Ask whether your plans become owned tasks with deadlines, or stay as documents.

04 **Is there one shared picture?**
Ask what leaders see live, and whether it needs someone to update a spreadsheet.

05 **Does it work when your systems do not?**
Ask how teams coordinate if email, chat or your network is down.

06 **Can frontline staff raise the alarm?**
Ask how a colleague on site escalates, with their location where available, in one action.

07 **What evidence does it leave behind?**
Ask for a sample timeline of the kind a regulator, insurer or inquiry would want.

08 **Can you rehearse in it?**
Ask whether you can run exercises on the same platform you would use for real.

SOURCES

Sources and notes

Sources were accessed in November 2026. Where reports differ, we say so in the text. Regulatory summaries are for orientation, not legal advice. Last reviewed: November 2026.

01 The Register, 4 June 2024, https://www.theregister.com/2024/06/04/suspected_cyberattack_hits_major_london/

02 NHS England London, Synnovis media statement, https://www.england.nhs.uk/london/synnovis-ransomware-cyber-attack/latest-media-statement-on-synnovis-cyber-attack/

03 NHSBT, 10 June 2024, https://www.nhsbt.nhs.uk/news/o-positive-and-o-negative-donors-asked-to-urgently-book-appointments-to-give-blood-following-london-hospitals-it-incident/

04 NHSBT, amber alert, 25 July 2024, https://www.nhsbt.nhs.uk/news/nhs-calls-national-blood-shortage-amber-alert/

05 The Record, 25 June 2025, https://therecord.media/ransomware-attack-contributed-patient-death-uk-nhs

06 The Record, 17 April 2026, https://therecord.media/ransomware-nhs-cyberattack-disruption

07 Healthcare Dive, 27 January 2025, https://www.healthcaredive.com/news/change-healthcare-cyberattack-affects-190-million-unitedhealth/738351/

08 AP via News4JAX, 10 May 2024, https://www.news4jax.com/health/2024/05/10/a-cyberattack-forces-a-big-us-health-system-to-divert-ambulances-and-take-records-offline/

09 PublicTechnology, 31 July 2026, https://www.publictechnology.net/2026/07/31/health-and-social-care/east-kent-hospitals-declare-critical-incident-over-ongoing-it-issues/

10 ITV News Meridian, 24 June 2026, https://www.itv.com/news/meridian/2026-06-24/hospital-declares-critical-incident-as-heat-causes-cooling-systems-to-fail

11 Express and Star (PA), 18 June 2025, https://www.expressandstar.com/uk-news/2025/06/18/170-patients-harmed-as-a-result-of-cyber-attack

12 Digital Health, June 2026, https://www.digitalhealth.net/2026/06/nhs-hospitals-declare-critical-incidents-as-heat-causes-it-failures/

13 European Commission, NIS2 FAQs, https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/faqs/directive-measures-high-common-level-cybersecurity-across-union-nis2-directive-faqs

14 DHSC, NIS Regulations 2018: health sector guide, https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/network-and-information-systems-regulations-2018-health-sector-guide

15 DSIT, Cyber Security and Resilience Bill: incident reporting, updated 3 November 2026, https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/cyber-security-and-resilience-network-and-information-systems-bill-factsheets/incident-reporting

16 National Audit Office, WannaCry and the NHS, 27 October 2017, https://www.nao.org.uk/reports/investigation-wannacry-cyber-attack-and-the-nhs/

17 The Record, 26 November 2024, https://therecord.media/england-hospitals-cyberattack-nhs-wirral

18 Digital Health, June 2026, https://www.digitalhealth.net/2026/06/almost-33000-bedfordshire-patients-had-data-stolen-in-cyber-attack/

SOURCES

Sources and notes

Sources continued. Secondary reporting is used only where it adds detail. Regulatory summaries are for orientation, not legal advice. Last reviewed: November 2026.

19 NHSBT, alert stood down, 18 July 2025, https://www.nhsbt.nhs.uk/news/national-blood-shortage-alert-to-be-stood-down-from-21-july-following-amazing-response-from-donors-and-hospitals/

20 The Register, 13 November 2025, https://www.theregister.com/2025/11/13/synnovis_qilin_investigation/

21 ICO, March 2025, https://ico.org.uk/about-the-ico/media-centre/news-and-blogs/2025/03/software-provider-fined-3m-following-2022-ransomware-attack/

22 NHS England, EPRR Framework v3, July 2022, https://www.england.nhs.uk/wp-content/uploads/2022/07/B0900-NHS-Emergency-Preparedness-Resilience-and-Response-Framework-version-3.pdf

23 NHS England, 2026/27 EPRR annual assurance, https://www.england.nhs.uk/long-read/2026-27-eprr-annual-assurance-process/

24 Oxford University Hospitals, EPRR Core Standards report, January 2025, https://www.ouh.nhs.uk/media/ca4h3l5n/tb202511-eprrcs-report.pdf

25 NHS England, Integrated OPEL framework 2024 to 2026, https://www.england.nhs.uk/long-read/integrated-opel-framework-2024-to-2026/

26 42 CFR 482.15 (Cornell LII), https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/42/482.15

27 ASPR TRACIE, Joint Commission EM standards, https://asprtracie.hhs.gov/technical-resources/resource/10609/new-and-revised-emncy-management-standards

28 45 CFR 164.404 (Cornell LII), https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/45/164.404

29 ASPR TRACIE, HICS Guidebook, 5th edition, https://asprtracie.hhs.gov/technical-resources/resource/2735/hospital-incident-command-system-hics-guidebook-fifth-edition-may-2014

30 European Commission, CER Directive, https://home-affairs.ec.europa.eu/policies/internal-security/counter-terrorism-and-radicalisation/protection/critical-infrastructure-resilience_en

31 DHA, Healthcare Emergencies, Crises and Disasters Management Framework, https://www.dha.gov.ae/uploads/112024/DHA%20Healthcare%20Emergencies%20Crises%20&%20Disasters%20Management%20Framework2024112683.pdf

32 Abu Dhabi Media Office, 8 May 2025, https://www.mediaoffice.abudhabi/en/health/emergencies-crises-and-disasters-management-centre-abu-dhabi-and-department-of-health-abu-dhabi-launch-business-continuity-management-standard-for-healthcare-activities/

33 ENEC, Business continuity management (NCEMA 7000), https://www.enec.ae/about-us/leadership-and-governance/-business-continuity-management/

34 Cureus, CBAHI narrative review, 2025, https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12635948/

35 JCI via PR Newswire, 1 July 2024, https://www.aap.com.au/aapreleases/cision20240701ae51644

BOOK YOUR HEALTHCARE PLATFORM DEMONSTRATION

Watch a pathology outage run end to end.

Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end. In a live, 30-minute demonstration built around a healthcare incident, you will see how our incident management software, an Operational Incident Coordination Platform, takes one incident from first alert to final report. Bring your own scenario.

WHAT YOU WILL SEE

01	SOS	A laboratory manager reports a system outage, with location where available.
02	PING	On-call, clinical and digital leads are alerted; call-in responses come back.
03	INCIDENT MANAGER	The incident is declared, roles assigned and partners added.
04	TASK MANAGER	Downtime procedures in each department become owned tasks.
05	CONTROL CENTRE	The incident team sees services affected, staff mobilised and actions outstanding.
06	AUDIT & REPORTING	The record for assurance, regulators and the after-action review is produced.
07	CRAIG	CRAiG helps the incident team find information in the platform and summarise the incident so far.

Book your demonstration →

crises-control.com/healthcare-incident-management-software/

+44 (0) 20 8584 1385 · contactus@crises-control.com

SCAN TO BOOK

COMPANION PLAYBOOK Major incident, minute one